

Examiner
only

6. The kestrel (*Falco tinnunculus*) is a bird of prey found in Pembrokeshire, Wales. The photographs show a kestrel in flight and nesting.



Surveys are carried out by the Welsh Kite Trust to monitor the numbers of kestrels in Pembrokeshire. The data gathered by some of these surveys are shown in **Table 6.1**.

Table 6.1

Year	Number of breeding pairs
2010	12
2011	19
2012	14
2016	10

- (a) (i) Calculate the percentage decrease in breeding pairs between 2011 and 2016. Use the formula below.

[2]

Percentage decrease = $\frac{\text{number of breeding pairs in 2011} - \text{number of breeding pairs in 2016}}{\text{number of breeding pairs in 2011}} \times 100$

Percentage decrease in breeding pairs =

- (ii) Suggest **two** possible reasons for this decrease.

[2]

1.

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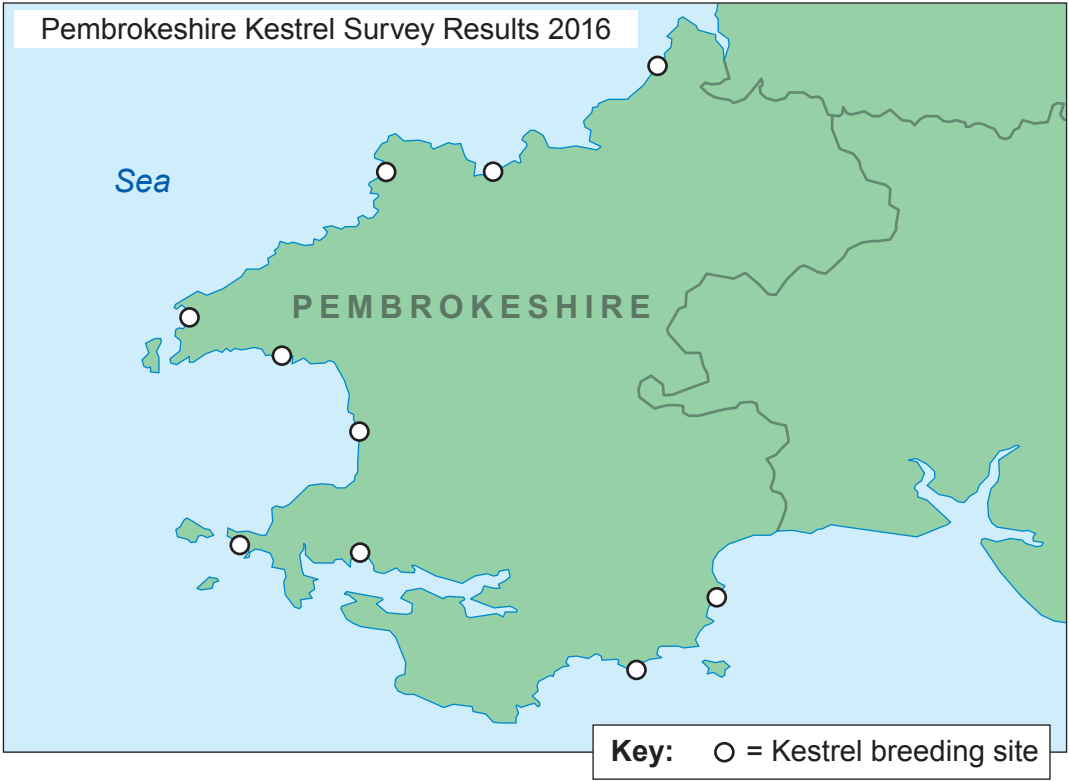
2.

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(b) **Image 6.2** shows a map of the nesting sites of kestrels in Pembrokeshire.

Image 6.2



State **one** conclusion that can be made about where kestrels generally choose to nest.
Suggest a reason for this. [2]

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(c) Another bird of prey called the merlin (*Falco columbarius*) is closely related to the kestrel. Use your knowledge of classification to state the evidence that supports this. [1]

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7

